



ICPSR 37679

Radicalization on the Internet: Virtual Extremism in the United States, 2015-2017

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Questionnaire for Online Extremism Survey
Data Wave 3



National Institute of Justice
Data Resources Program

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Online Extremism: 3rd Wave

Start of Block: Block 1

Q1 Hello, we are researching the expression of extremist and hateful opinions on the web, and we would like to invite you to participate in our study. The following information is provided to inform you of the research project that will be conducted by Dr. Matthew Costello, Dr. James Hawdon, Dr. David Snow, and others. The research is funded by the National Institute of Justice under Grant Number 2014-ZA-BX-0014. **PURPOSE OF THE STUDY:** The purpose of this study is to investigate the use of social networking sites (SNS) among Americans and if they have seen or heard materials that express hateful or extremely negative attitudes towards people or groups. We are interested to see if the use of SNS influences if people see these materials and if seeing such materials are related to people's levels of trust, online activities, and other experiences.

PROCEDURES: You are being asked to complete an online questionnaire about SNS use and extremist materials online. If you decide to participate, completing the interview will require about ten minutes. You will not be identified in any way, and your answers will remain confidential. There will be no way anyone will find out who you are or how you answered these questions. All results of this research will be reported in aggregate form so no individuals could be identified. The de-identified data will be archived and made available to the public at the National Archive of Criminal Justice Data.

RISKS: This survey will ask you questions about your online experiences. It will also ask you questions about your levels of trust in various people and institutions. The questions are not about sensitive topics, although some items will ask if you have seen or been a target of harassing materials online. However, we believe this research poses no risks to you.

Q2 **BENEFITS:** There is a societal benefit of increasing the understanding the extent to which hateful and extremist materials are online, how people respond when they see these materials, and how these materials influences individuals' levels of trust in others.

COMPENSATION: There is no compensation for participation in this project other than that possibly provided by Survey Sample International (SSI).

FREEDOM TO WITHDRAW: By agreeing to participate in the study, you do not waive any rights that you may have regarding access to and disclosure of your records. Your participation in this study is completely voluntary. If you choose to participate, your responses will be held in confidence. You are free to withdraw at any time without penalty. In addition, you also understand that you may skip any question that you do not want to answer. Finally, if the results of this study were to be written for publication, no identifying information will be used.

APPROVAL OF RESEARCH: This study has been reviewed and approved by Arkansas State University's Institutional Review Board (IRB). The IRB has determined that this study meets the ethical obligations required by federal law and University policies. If you have questions or concerns regarding this study please contact the Investigator or Advisor. If you have any questions regarding your rights as a research subject, please contact the Director of Research Compliance at 870-972-2694.

PARTICIPANTS RESPONSIBILITY: You are responsible for answering the questions you choose to answer. If you have any questions or concerns about this research, please contact Dr. James Hawdon at 540-231-7476. You can also contact Dr. Hawdon at hawdonj@vt.edu or by mail at Center for Peace Studies and Violence Prevention, Virginia Tech, 205a Norris Hall, 495 Old Turner St. Blacksburg, VA 24061.

Q3 PARTICIPANTS CONSENT: I have read and understood the Informed Consent Statement and conditions of this project. By highlighting "Begin Survey" below, I hereby acknowledge the above, I assert I am 18 years of age or older, and I give my voluntary consent for participation in this project.

Highlight your choice and click on the arrows below.

- ☐ Begin the Survey (1)
- ☐ No Thank you. I'd rather not participate. (2)

Q7 Are you

- ☐ Male (1)
- ☐ Female (2)

Q8 In what year were you born?

Q9 In What region of the country do you live.?

- ☐ Northeast (1)
- ☐ Midwest (2)
- ☐ South (3)
- ☐ West (4)

Q10 Were you born in the U.S.?

- ☐ Yes (1)
 - ☐ No (2)
-

Q11 Were either of your parents born outside the U.S.?

- ☐ Yes (1)
 - ☐ No (2)
-

Q12 How would you describe where you live?

- ☐ a large city (over 250,000) (1)
 - ☐ a medium-size city (50,000-250,000) (2)
 - ☐ a small city or town (Under 50,000) (3)
 - ☐ a suburb near a city (4)
 - ☐ open country or a rural area (5)
-

Q13 Are you currently:

- ☐ Living alone (1)
 - ☐ Married or living with a partner, no children in the home (2)
 - ☐ Single parent (3)
 - ☐ Married or living with a partner, children in the home (4)
 - ☐ Living with parents (5)
 - ☐ Other family type (e.g. living with roommates) (6)
-

Q14 Which is the highest level of education you have achieved?

- ☐ Less than a High School diploma (1)
 - ☐ High School Degree (2)
 - ☐ Some college (3)
 - ☐ A college degree (4)
 - ☐ A master's degree, professional degree or higher (5)
-

Q15 What is your main occupation? Select all that apply.

☐

I'm in school (1)

☐

I'm in a paid, full-time job (2)

☐

I'm in a paid, part-time job and not looking for full-time work (3)

☐

I'm in a paid, part-time job but looking for full-time work (4)

☐

I'm unemployed/ looking for a job (5)

☐

I'm unemployed/ not looking for a job (6)

Q16 What is your race? Select all that apply.

- ☐ White (1)
 - ☐ Black or African American (2)
 - ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native (3)
 - ☐ Asian Indian (4)
 - ☐ Chinese (5)
 - ☐ Filipino (6)
 - ☐ Japanese (7)
 - ☐ Korean (8)
 - ☐ Vietnamese (9)
 - ☐ Other Asian (10)
 - ☐ Native Hawaiian (11)
 - ☐ Guamanian or Chamorro (12)
 - ☐ Samoan (13)
 - ☐ Other Pacific Islander (14)
 - ☐ Other Race (15)
 - ☐ Prefer not to answer (16)
-

Q17 Are you Hispanic?

☐ Yes (1)

☐ No (2)

Q18 In the past 3 months, which of the following services have you used? Choose all that apply.

- ☐ Facebook (1)
- ☐ YouTube (2)
- ☐ Instagram (3)
- ☐ Twitter (4)
- ☐ Google+ (5)
- ☐ MySpace (6)
- ☐ Wikipedia (7)
- ☐ Tumblr (8)
- ☐ Pinterest (9)
- ☐ Snapchat (10)
- ☐ Newspaper message boards (11)
- ☐ General message boards (12)
- ☐ 4chan or 8chan (13)
- ☐ Image boards other than 4chan or 8chan (14)
- ☐ Instant messengers (e.g. Windows Live messenger) (15)
- ☐ Online role-playing games or MMO (e.g. World of Warcraft, Runescape, etc.) (16)
- ☐ First-person shooter games or FPS (e.g. Call of Duty, Battlefield, etc.) (17)
- ☐ Dating services (eHarmony, Match, Kik, Tinder, etc.) (18)

- ☐ Blogs or Forums (19)
 - ☐ Email (20)
 - ☐ Skype (21)
 - ☐ Anonymous network (e.g. Tor, Freenet, I2P, YikYak) (22)
 - ☐ Reddit (23)
-

Q19 Approximately how many hours per day do you use the Internet?

- ☐ Less than one hour per day (1)
 - ☐ One or two hours per day (2)
 - ☐ Three to five hours per day (3)
 - ☐ Six to seven hours per day (4)
 - ☐ Eight to nine hours per day (5)
 - ☐ Ten or more hours per day (6)
-

Q20 In the past 3 months, have you seen hateful or degrading writings or speech online that attacked certain groups of people or individuals?

- ☐ Yes (1)
 - ☐ No (2)
-

Q21 In the past 3 months, have you seen or heard any materials online that expressed negative views about any group because of the group's race, nationality, ethnicity, sexual orientation, gender, gender identity, political views, immigrant status, or religion?

☐ Yes (1)

☐ No (2)

Skip To: Q24 If In the past 3 months, have you seen or heard any materials online that expressed negative views a... = No

Q22 Thinking of the most recent time when you saw or heard negative views expressed about a group, how would you best describe those views? (check all that apply)

- ☐ They advocated violence against the group (1)
 - ☐ They used stereotypes to describe the group (2)
 - ☐ They blamed the group for their problems (3)
 - ☐ They blamed the group for the nation's problems (4)
 - ☐ They advocated hatred of the group (5)
 - ☐ They called for others to discriminate against the group (6)
-

Q23 Did the negative views that you saw or heard online pertain to one or more of the following? (Check all that apply)

- ☐ Ethnicity or race (1)
 - ☐ Nationality or immigrant status (2)
 - ☐ Sexual orientation (3)
 - ☐ Religious conviction/belief (4)
 - ☐ Political Views (5)
 - ☐ Disability (6)
 - ☐ Sex or Gender (7)
 - ☐ Gender Identity (8)
 - ☐ Appearance (9)
 - ☐ Other (10) _____
-

Q24 Please indicate which of the following services you saw or heard negative views. Choose all that apply.

Facebook (1)

YouTube (2)

Instagram (3)

Twitter (4)

Google+ (5)

MySpace (6)

Wikipedia (7)

Tumblr (8)

Pinterest (9)

Snapchat (10)

Newspaper message boards (11)

General message boards (12)

4chan or 8chan (13)

Image boards other than 4chan or 8chan (14)

Instant messengers (e.g. Windows Live messenger) (15)

Online role-playing games or MMO (e.g. World of Warcraft, Runescape, etc.) (16)

First-person shooter games or FPS (e.g. Call of Duty, Battlefield, etc.) (17)

Dating services (eHarmony, Match, Kik, Tinder, etc.) (18)

Blogs or Forums (19)

Email (20)

Skype (21)

Anonymous network (e.g. Tor, Freenet, I2P, YikYak) (22)

Reddit (23)

Q25 Still thinking of the most recent time you saw negative material online, did you purposefully search for this material or did you find it by accident?

☐ I searched for it (1)

☐ I got there by accident (2)

☐ I got the link to the site from a friend (3)

Q26 To what extent did you agree with the opinions expressed in the material you saw or heard?

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
 - ☐ Somewhat agree (2)
 - ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
 - ☐ Somewhat disagree (4)
 - ☐ Strongly disagree (5)
-

Q27 In your opinion, how disturbing was this material? Please assess on a scale from 1–5, when 1 = extremely disturbing and 5= not at all disturbing.

- ☐ 1= Extremely disturbing (1)
 - ☐ 2= very disturbing (2)
 - ☐ 3= disturbing (3)
 - ☐ 4= only slightly disturbing (4)
 - ☐ 5= Not at all disturbing (5)
-

Q28 How frequently do you see material online that expresses negative views toward some group?

- ☐ I never see this type of material (1)
 - ☐ I see this type of material very infrequently (2)
 - ☐ I see this type of material occasionally (3)
 - ☐ I see this type of material frequently (4)
-

Q29 Have you ever personally been the target of hateful or degrading material online?

☐ Yes (1)

☐ No (2)

Display This Question:

If Have you ever personally been the target of hateful or degrading material online? = Yes

Q30 Thinking of the last time you were targeted, to which of the following did the hateful or degrading material that targeted you pertain? Choose all relevant options.

☐ Ethnicity or race (1)

☐ Nationality (2)

☐ Sexual orientation (3)

☐ Religious conviction/beliefs (4)

☐ Political views (5)

☐ Disability (6)

☐ Sex or Gender (7)

☐ Gender identity (8)

☐ Appearance (9)

☐ Other (10) _____

Q31 How often do you see people using language, images or humor on social networking sites that you find offensive?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q32 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you tell the person who is being offensive to stop?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q33 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you defend the person or group being attacked?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q34 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you ignore what is being said?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q35 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you join in the mean or offensive behavior?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q36 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have others told the person who is being offensive to stop?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q37 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have others defended the person or group being attacked?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q38 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have others joined in the mean or offensive behavior?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q39 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have site administrators deleted their offensive comments or otherwise halted their mean or offensive behavior?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q40 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have you seen others persuade those who post the material to stop being mean or offensive?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q41 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have you seen others report the material to the site administrator?

- ☐ Never (1)
 - ☐ Only once in a while (2)
 - ☐ Sometimes (3)
 - ☐ Frequently (4)
-

Q42 Please answer the following question using a scale from 1–10, where 1 = not very true of me, and 10 = very true of me.

	1= Not very true of me (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5 (5)	6 (6)	7 (7)	8 (8)	9 (9)	10= Very true of me (10)
I have high self-esteem (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I enjoy taking risks (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I find it easier to talk about private things online when others don't know who I am. (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of my friends have downloaded music or movies illegally. (4)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I often do things that feel good in the moment, but I regret later on. (5)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Sometimes I can't stop myself from doing things my friends are doing, even if I know it is wrong. (6)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q43 Please respond to the following statement using a scale of 1 – 5, where 1 = strongly disagree, and 5 = strongly agree.

	1= strongly disagree (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5= Strongly agree (5)
Laws are made to be broken. (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is okay to do anything you want as long as you don't hurt anyone. (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fighting between friends or within families is nobody else's business. (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q44 Would you say that the following people can be trusted, or that you can't be too careful in dealing with these people? Assess on a scale from 1–10, where 1 = you can't be too careful and 10 = can be fully trusted

	1= you can't be too careful (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5 (5)	6 (6)	7 (7)	8 (8)	9 (9)	10= can be fully trusted (10)
People in general (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
People met only online (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Politicians in general (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The president (4)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The police (5)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Business leaders (6)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q45 How close do you feel to each of the following? Please indicate on a scale from 1 to 5 where 1 = not at all close and 5 = very close

	1= Not at all close (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5= Very close (5)	Not applicable (6)
Your family (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Your friends (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
An online community to which you belong (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
A religious community (4)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q46 How important is religion in your life?

- ☐ 1= Not at all important (1)
- ☐ 2 (2)
- ☐ 3 (3)
- ☐ 4 (4)
- ☐ 5= Very important (5)
- ☐ Not applicable (6)
-

Q47 What religion do you most align with?

- ☐ None (1)
 - ☐ Protestant Christian (2)
 - ☐ Catholicism (3)
 - ☐ Judaism (4)
 - ☐ Islam (5)
 - ☐ Buddhism (6)
 - ☐ Hinduism (7)
 - ☐ Other (8) _____
-

Q48 Please answer the following question using a scale from 1-10, where 1= not at all and 10= completely. Do conventional religious institutions meet your religious and spiritual needs?

- ☐ 1= Not at all (1)
 - ☐ 2 (2)
 - ☐ 3 (3)
 - ☐ 4 (4)
 - ☐ 5 (5)
 - ☐ 6 (6)
 - ☐ 7 (7)
 - ☐ 8 (8)
 - ☐ 9 (9)
 - ☐ 10= Completely (10)
-

Q49 How satisfied are you with the way things are going in the United States right now?

- ☐ Completely dissatisfied (1)
 - ☐ Mostly dissatisfied (2)
 - ☐ Somewhat dissatisfied (3)
 - ☐ Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied (4)
 - ☐ Somewhat satisfied (5)
 - ☐ Mostly satisfied (6)
 - ☐ Completely satisfied (7)
-

Q50 Using a scale from 0 to 10, with 0 representing "Not at all," 10 representing "Completely," and 5 representing "In the middle," please respond to the following:

	0 Not at all (1)	1 (2)	2 (3)	3 (4)	4 (5)	In the middle 5 (6)	6 (7)	7 (8)	8 (9)	9 (10)	10 Completely (11)
How much is being American an important part of how you see yourself? (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How proud are you to be an American? (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How much do you think people in the world respect Americans? (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In general, how much do you find that being American influences or guides how you behave? (4)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Think about how you see yourself as American. How much do you think your friends see you as American? (5)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q51 Please answer the following question using a scale from 1-10, where 1= not at all and 10= completely. How well do you think the DEMOCRATIC PARTY protects what is important to you?

- ☐ 1 = not at all (1)
 - ☐ 2 (2)
 - ☐ 3 (3)
 - ☐ 4 (4)
 - ☐ 5 (5)
 - ☐ 6 (6)
 - ☐ 7 (7)
 - ☐ 8 (8)
 - ☐ 9 (9)
 - ☐ 10= completely (10)
-

Q52 Please answer the following question using a scale from 1-10, where 1= not at all and 10= completely. How well do you think the REPUBLICAN PARTY protects what is important to you?

- ☐ 1 = not at all (1)
 - ☐ 2 (2)
 - ☐ 3 (3)
 - ☐ 4 (4)
 - ☐ 5 (5)
 - ☐ 6 (6)
 - ☐ 7 (7)
 - ☐ 8 (8)
 - ☐ 9 (9)
 - ☐ 10= completely (10)
-

Q53 On a scale of 1 to 7, how would you rank your political views?

- ☐ 1= Extremely Liberal (1)
 - ☐ 2= Liberal (2)
 - ☐ 3= Slightly Liberal (3)
 - ☐ 4= Moderate (4)
 - ☐ 5= Slightly Conservative (5)
 - ☐ 6= Conservative (6)
 - ☐ 7= Extremely conservative (7)
 - ☐ 8= Don't Know (8)
-

Q54 How well is Donald Trump doing as president?

- ☐ Excellent (1)
 - ☐ Good (2)
 - ☐ Average (3)
 - ☐ Poor (4)
 - ☐ Terrible (5)
-

Q55 Have you expressed political views on the Internet in the past year?

- ☐ Yes (1)
 - ☐ No (2)
-

Q56 Have you ever produced online material that other people would likely interpret as hateful or degrading?

- ☐ Yes (1)
 - ☐ No (2)
-

Display This Question:

If Have you ever produced online material that other people would likely interpret as hateful or deg... = Yes

Q57 Are you a member of a group that produces online material that other people often interpret as hateful or degrading?

- ☐ Yes (1)
 - ☐ No (2)
-

Q58 In your own opinion, have you been a target/victim of an online crime?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Display This Question:

If In your own opinion, have you been a target/victim of an online crime? = Yes

Q59 How long ago were you the target/victim of an online crime?

- ☐ Within the last three months (1)
- ☐ 3 months to a year ago (2)
- ☐ More than a year ago (3)

Display This Question:

If In your own opinion, have you been a target/victim of an online crime? = Yes

Q60 Which crime was this?

- ☐ Slander or defamation of your character (1)
- ☐ Coercion or a threat of violence (2)
- ☐ Identity theft (3)
- ☐ Fraud (4)
- ☐ Sexual harassment (5)
- ☐ Other (6)

Display This Question:

If Which crime was this? = Other

Q61 What crime?

Q62 Below you can give feedback to the authors of the questionnaire. Were any questions ambiguous or hard to understand? Did you feel like some important answer options were missing? All feedback is very welcome!

End of Block: Default Question Block
